

5 Introduction to fstab

All the necessary information required to automate the process of mounting partitions, i.e., the the process where a raw (physical) partition is prepared for access and assigned a location on the file system tree (or mount point) is contained in the configuration file `/etc/fstab`.

Partitions listed in `fstab` can be configured to automatically mount during the boot process. If a device/partition is not listed in `fstab` ONLY ROOT can mount the device/partition, whereas users can mount a device/partition if the device is in `fstab` with the proper options.

fields	description
<device>	The device/partition (by <code>/dev</code> location or UUID) that contain a file system.
<mount point>	The directory on your root file system (aka mount point) from which it will be possible to access the content of the device/partition (note: swap has no mount point). Mount points should not have spaces in the names.
<file system type>	Type of file system
<options>	Mount options of access to the device/partition (see the man page for mount).
<dump>	Enable or disable backing up of the device/partition (the command dump). This field is usually set to 0, which disables it.
<pass num>	Controls the order in which <code>fsck</code> checks the device/partition for errors at boot time. The root device should be 1. Other partitions should be 2, or 0 to disable checking.

5.1 Fstab file configuration

The syntax of a `fstab` entry is :

[Device] [Mount Point] [File System Type] [Options]
[Dump] [Pass]

Device

By default, Ubuntu now uses UUID to identify partitions.

UUID=xxx.yyy.zzz

To list your devices by UUID use `blkid`

`sudo blkid`

Alternately syntax to refer to partitions :

- Device : `/dev/sdxy`
- Label : `LABEL=label`
- Network ID
- Samba : `//server/share`
- NFS : `server:/share`